Ritam

PARTICIPANT HANDBOOK · ADVANCED COURSE

The Mind in the Light of Modern and Spiritual Sciences

MODULE 4

# Human Condition: Drift, Suffering & Wellbeing

*by Swami Tadananda*


- 4.1 From Source to Spectrum to Ritam
- 4.2 The Architecture of Manifestation: The Ritam Diagram
- 4.3 The Mind through the Lens of RWF I: The Wave Equation
- 4.4 Mind through the Lens of RWF II: The Inner Instrument
- 4.5 Inherited Mind: Saṁskāras, Vāsanās & Memory of Energy
- 4.6 Living in Harmony with Ṛta
- 4.7 When We Drift from Ṛta


© 2026 Ramakrishna Vedanta Centre (NZ). All rights reserved. This handbook is provided for the personal study of enrolled participants of the course. Please do not copy or share it.

# Notation and terms used in Module 4

The symbols and terms the seven lessons use, in the lessons' own wording, with the lesson where each first appears (the lesson that develops it is in brackets). Use it alongside the lesson pages.

| Term | In the lessons' words | First appears |
|---|---|---|
| **source; spectrum** | Source: the unmanifest (in physics the vacuum state; in the contemplative traditions Ātman / Brahman / Para). Spectrum: the range from awareness at the unmanifest pole (“0”) to differentiated form (“1 through 9”), a spectrum, not a binary. | 4.1 |
| **witness** | The awareness in which body, breath and thought arise; it has no shape, rate or content. It is not a term of the equation: buddhi's clarity lets the mind recognise “the awareness within which the equation is unfolding” (4.4). | 4.1 (named 4.2) |
| **Ritam; Ṛta** | Right-fittedness: the inherent fitting of things into their proper relationships. Ṛta, “often written Ritam in this course”: a being whose rhythms are aligned with the rhythms that hold it (4.6). | 4.1 (4.6) |
| **ṛtu** | Ritam-in-time: the natural rhythms of season, day, breath, hunger. | 4.1 |
| **anṛta** | “Not-Ṛta”: not moral falsehood but ontological misfit; drift from resonant fit. A structural condition, not a defect of the person (4.7). | 4.1 (4.7) |
| **the Ritam Diagram** | Nine points on a circle: form {1, 2, 4, 8, 7, 5} (doubling, reduced to one digit), rhythm {3, 6}, equilibrium {9}; every form-pair sums to 9. Not numerology. | 4.2 |
| **tamas; rajas; sattva** | Three strands, not valences: tamas (form), rajas (rhythm), sattva (equilibrium, the integrating axis). All indispensable; the question is which is over- or under-expressed. | 4.2 |
| **doubling; trebling** | “Doubling holds, trebling lifts”: the doubling-loop is the duality of mental life; trebling lifts it to {3, 6}, then {9}; 9 then involutes into 0: Self-Recognition (Pratyabhijñā). | 4.2 (4.3) |
| **torus** | “The natural three-dimensional form of a system that pulses”: form wraps its surface, rhythm pulses it at its natural frequency, the still axis runs through the centre. 4.5 uses it for the saṁskāra loop. | 4.2 |
| **$\psi_x(t)$; $f_s$** | The object-wave: what is actually present, with its own intrinsic frequency, which 4.3 writes $f_s$. | 4.3 |
| **$\psi_m(t)$; $f_m$; $A_m$** | The attention wave, deployed by manas, which sets its frequency $f_m$: $\psi_m(t) = A_m \cdot \cos(2\pi f_m t + \varphi_m)$. | 4.3 (4.4) |
| **G(t)** | The gain: the amplitude of the attention wave, set by the body and prāṇa (arousal, breath, posture). | 4.3 |
| **h(t); ∗** | The impulse response, the filter chitta's saṁskāras form; ∗ (convolution) is that record acting on the incoming signal. Its content is the totality of one's saṁskāras (4.5). | 4.3 (4.5) |
| **n(t)** | The noise term: everything that degrades the signal; small in Ritam, dominant in anṛta (4.7). | 4.3 (4.7) |
| **vṛtti; carrier; envelope; Δf** | Vṛtti: the whole resultant wave when knower and known meet. Carrier: the content layer, at the mean frequency $(f_s + f_m)/2$. Envelope: the clarity layer; its felt flicker of duality beats at $\Delta f = \lvert f_s - f_m \rvert$. | 4.3 |
| **citta-vṛtti-nirodha** | The stilling of the mind's fluctuations: Patañjali's phrase, which 4.3 reads as stilling the envelope into constant fullness. | 4.3 |
| **Δφ** | The standing phase-offset the attention wave carries into every meeting: ahaṁkāra; buddhi corrects it. | 4.3 (4.4) |
| **antaḥkaraṇa** | The inner instrument: manas sets $f_m$; buddhi corrects the phase and reads the carrier; ahaṁkāra is the standing tilt Δφ and tags moments as “mine”; chitta is the field whose saṁskāras form h(t). | 4.4 |
| **saṁskāra; vāsanā** | The energetic trace of an experience, a self-sustaining loop that fires when triggered; a cluster of related saṁskāras coupled into a larger pattern, as a character is to a habit. | 4.3 (4.5) |
| **sañcita; prārabdha; āgāmi** | The accumulated reservoir; the ripening present, the conditions of this life; what present action forms, ripening in future. Nivṛtti saṁskāras, formed by practice, soften the ripening. | 4.5 |
| **resonance; entrainment; coherence** | A system driven at its natural frequency amplifies; coupled oscillators with similar frequencies tend to synchronise; many systems hold a stable phase relationship, “coordinated diversity”. | 4.2 (4.6) |

**Plain words.** **Amplitude**: the height of a wave. **Frequency**: how fast it repeats its cycle; **Hz** (hertz) is cycles per second. **Phase**: where a wave is in its cycle. **Oscillator**: anything that repeats a cycle, such as a pendulum or a heart. **Convolution**: a past record shaping a new signal as it arrives. **HRV**: the natural variation in the time between heartbeats. **Circadian**: “about a day”, the body's roughly 24-hour clock.

**Two notes.** 4.3 writes the object frequency as $f_s$ and the handbook quotes it as written. The handbook writes Ṛta and Ritam as the lesson cited does.

**The module's equation** (as Lesson 4.3 writes it): $\psi exp(t) = [\psi_x(t) * h(t)] + G(t) \cdot \psi_m(t) + n(t)$

# Lesson 4.1: From Source to Spectrum to Ritam

**Aim:** to walk three connected questions, Who am I?, Where do I come from? and What holds it all together?, and to see that the answers form one architectural picture, with Ritam, right-fittedness, holding it together. **Online:** understanding check for 4.1 (vedanta.nz, My Journey). Lesson 4.1 has no Practice page.

## 1 In my own words

In three sentences, answer the lesson's three questions in your own words: who you are, where you come from, and what holds it all together.

## 2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

| Term | In my own words |
|---|---|
| Source-pole, "0" | |
| Manifest spectrum, "1 through 9" | |
| Vacuum state | |
| Spectral and temporal domains | |
| Sṛṣṭi | |
| Laya | |
| Ritam | |
| Anṛta | |

## 3 Fill the gaps

The vacuum state is not empty space: it is the substrate from which particles arise as _____ of an underlying field.

The prism does not create the colours; it _____ what was already present in the white light.

The most accurate single English word the lesson gives for Ritam is _____.

## 4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

*"The unmanifest source, "0", is nothing at all: an empty void with no role in the number system or in nature."*

*"Being and Becoming are two separate realities, so a person who suffers has somehow left Being for Becoming."*

# Lesson 4.1: From Source to Spectrum to Ritam (continued)

## 5 Draw it in your own way

**Figure 4.1.d.** The lesson's caption reads: "The breathing of manifestation: energy unfolds outward into form (sṛṣṭi) and returns inward to source (laya). Health is not a fixed point on the spectrum but the living rhythm between the two." Draw this in any way you like. Show the source ("0") at one end and form at the other, and mark the outward and the inward movement. At the foot of the frame write one example the lesson gives of each.

**Outward and inward**

Outward (sṛṣṭi), one example:

Inward (laya), one example:

## 6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Mele has two conversations in one day. In the first, she and a friend take turns, listening and speaking easily. In the second, a colleague talks over everyone and one person says nothing. Using the lesson's section on recognising Ritam, say where Ritam shows in the first, and what the lesson says its absence looks like in the second. Do not describe yourself.

## 7 Tracker

Module 4 builds the Ritam Wellbeing Framework (RWF) lesson by lesson, and the wave equation arrives in 4.3. Lesson 4.1 has no equation. In the lesson's own words, write the three questions and the three answers it holds. End with the lesson's own line on how far the architecture has got.

## 8 Check my notes

Key points for 4.1 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

# 4.1 From Source to Spectrum to Ritam

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

### The main ideas

- The lesson walks three questions: Who am I? Where do I come from? What holds it all together? The answers form one picture: a spectrum, an unmanifest source, and Ritam.
- In the self-inquiry, body, breath and thought are each real, changing and observable. What observes them has no shape, rate or content and does not arise or dissolve: closer to what you are than any content.
- The lesson names that awareness "0", the unmanifest source-pole, and differentiated content "1 through 9". It is a spectrum, not a binary: deep sleep is closer to "0" than waking.
- The vacuum state of physics is not empty: it is the substrate from which particles arise as excitations of a field. The lesson uses it as the closest analogue to "0". Vedānta calls the source Ātman and Brahman; Kashmir Shaivism, Para.
- White light is the spectrum undifferentiated: the colours were already there. So Being and Becoming are one reality in a spectral domain (all at once, beyond time) and a temporal domain (sequenced), never two realities.
- Outward, sṛṣṭi (differentiation), and inward, laya (integration): health is the rhythm of the two. Suffering is rarely about which point a person is at, but whether this breathing-movement is functioning.
- Ritam, from the root √ṛ, is best rendered "right-fittedness". The lesson names three domains of one principle: physical, ritual (timing of action) and ethical (fittedness of relationship), and finds it at every level.
- Anṛta, the negation of Ritam, is "dis-jointed, mis-fit": what loses fit becomes ill. Detail is left to 4.7, and the practices that restore fit to Module 5.

### Terms

| | |
|---|---|
| **Source-pole "0"** | The unmanifest end of the spectrum: awareness itself. |
| **Manifest spectrum** | "1 through 9": from the most subtle to the most differentiated content. |
| **Vacuum state** | In physics, the lowest-energy condition of a quantum field: not empty, but the substrate of particles. |
| **Sṛṣṭi and laya** | Outward movement of manifestation and inward movement of return. |
| **Ritam / Anṛta** | Right-fittedness, the fitting of things into their proper relationships / its negation. |

### Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** excitations; differentiates; right-fittedness.
- **Slips:** the source is not nothing: the vacuum state is not empty, and "0" is the position-holder that makes value-bearing positions possible. Being and Becoming are one reality in two views, both present in every moment; the lesson places suffering in the rhythm between the two views falling out of fittedness.
- **Figure:** a drawing of your own showing source at one end, form at the other, outward and inward movement and the rhythm between them. Lesson examples: outward, a breath beginning as an impulse, a thought as a pre-verbal sense, a child from a single cell; inward, the exhalation completing, a thought forgotten, the body sleeping.
- **Apply:** Ritam shows in the first conversation as turn-taking, listening and speaking in fitted rhythm. Its absence, the lesson says, is when "someone dominates, someone disappears, the rhythm is broken".
- **Tracker:** Who am I? A manifest being arrayed on a spectrum from gross to subtle, with awareness at one pole and form at the other. Where do I come from? An unmanifest source, the vacuum state in physics and Ātman / Brahman / Para in the contemplative traditions. What holds it all together? Ritam, right-fittedness, at every scale. The lesson: "The architecture has been pointed at, not yet drawn."

# 4.1 From Source to Spectrum to Ritam: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

### What I want to remember

### Questions I would like to ask

### Where I notice this in my own life

# Lesson 4.2: The Architecture of Manifestation: The Ritam Diagram

**Aim:** to build the Ritam Diagram in numbers and in Sanskrit, meet the torus as its three-dimensional form, and use the three guṇas as a diagnostic lens: three strands, not good or bad. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 4.2 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

## 1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what each strand is (its numbers and Sanskrit name) and why the guṇas are strands, not valences (rankings of good and bad).

## 2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

| Term | In my own words |
|---|---|
| Digital root | |
| Doubling loop, {1, 2, 4, 8, 7, 5} | |
| Pulsation pair, {3, 6} | |
| Integrating axis, 9 | |
| Guṇa | |
| Trebling | |
| Natural frequency | |
| Torus | |

## 3 Fill the gaps

Doubling 1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32 and taking the digital root of each gives a closed cycle of _____ numbers.

The three strands are form (tamas), rhythm (rajas) and _____ (sattva).

Trebling is the algebra of ascent: tamas trebled becomes rajas, and rajas trebled becomes _____.

## 4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

*"Tamas is the bad strand to escape, rajas the neutral one, sattva the good one."*

*"The diagram is numerology: the numbers 1 to 9 carry mystical powers."*

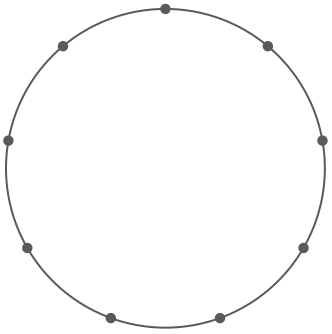
# Lesson 4.2: The Architecture of Manifestation: The Ritam Diagram

(continued)

## 5 Draw it in your own way

**Figure 4.2.b.** The lesson's caption reads: “The Ritam Diagram: nine points hold three families. The form-loop (tamas, {1,2,4,8,7,5}) traces a hexagram, the rhythm-axis (rajas, {3,6}) pulses across it, and the integrating apex (sattva, 9) holds the whole. Every form-pair sums to 9.” The lesson describes the diagram in sections 2 to 5: nine equally spaced points on a circle, numbered 1 to 9 clockwise from the top, with 9 at the apex. Number the points on the circle, draw the form-loop in the order the doubling gives, draw the 3-6 axis, and mark the apex. Beside it, write each strand with its numbers and its Sanskrit name.

**The Ritam Diagram (blank circle)**



**The three strands**

Form: numbers, name

Rhythm: numbers, name

Equilibrium: number, name

One pair that sums to 9:

## 6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Ngaio, a carpenter, says: “I want to get rid of the heavy, stubborn part of me and keep only the calm.” Using the lesson's section “Three Strands, Not Three Valences”, say what the lesson would invite her to ask instead, and what it says would be missing if tamas could be escaped. Do not describe yourself.

## 7 Tracker

The module has no equation yet. In the lesson's own words, write what Lesson 4.2 adds to the picture begun in 4.1: the three strands, what trebling does, and the form in which the architecture lives in three dimensions. End with where the lesson says its geometric model now stands.

## 8 Check my notes

Key points for 4.2 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

# 4.2 The Architecture of Manifestation: The Ritam Diagram

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

## The main ideas

- Not numerology: the numbers 1 to 9, taken modulo 9 (counting back round to 1 after 9), are convenient, not magical, and the diagram displays the architecture without being it. A digital root adds a number's digits until one is left.
- Form, tamas: doubling 1, 2, 4, 8, 16 (root 7), 32 (root 5) gives the closed loop {1, 2, 4, 8, 7, 5}, a hexagram. Tamas is persistence, density and stability, not a negative quality; it is problematic only when it dominates.
- Rhythm, rajas: from 3, doubling gives 3, 6, 3, 6, the simplest oscillation (breath, heartbeat, day and night). The lesson links rajas to Spanda from Module 1.
- Equilibrium, sattva: 9 absorbs whatever it multiplies, and each form-pair sums to 9 (1+8, 2+7, 4+5). It is the still apex, integrated motion like a balanced spinning top.
- The lesson says breath is the rhythm you can engage at will. Trebling, multiplying by 3, lifts the form family onto {3, 6}, and 3 and 6 onto 9; 9 trebled returns to 9. The lesson names this the Breath Shortcut: rhythm has a direct path to integration.
- The torus: form wraps its surface, rhythm is its pulsation at its natural frequency, and the still axis runs through the centre. The lesson says it is one organising form among many.
- The guṇas are three indispensable strands, not valences. The question is which is over- or under-expressed. The lesson's vignettes of tamasic and rajasic drift are structural, never moral; 4.7 develops them.

## Terms

| | |
|---|---|
| **Digital root** | Add a number's digits repeatedly until one digit remains. |
| **Doubling loop** | {1, 2, 4, 8, 7, 5}: form-giving recurrence, tamas. |
| **Trebling** | Multiplying by 3: “the algebra of ascent”, lifting form to rhythm and rhythm to equilibrium. |
| **Natural frequency** | The rate at which each form expands, contracts and sustains itself. |
| **Torus** | A doughnut shape: the diagram in three dimensions, pulsating at its natural frequency. |

## Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** six; equilibrium; sattva.
- **Slips:** the guṇas are three indispensable strands, not valences: none can be escaped, and the question is which is over- or under-expressed. The numbers are convenient, not magical: the diagram displays the architecture and is not the architecture.
- **Figure:** the Ritam Diagram is the lesson's own figure, so look for: nine equally spaced points numbered 1 to 9 clockwise from the top with 9 at the apex; the loop 1, 2, 4, 8, 7, 5 and back to 1 as a hexagram; 3 and 6 on either side of 9, joined by the horizontal 3-6 axis; 9 marked; strands matched to tamas (form), rajas (rhythm), sattva (equilibrium).
- **Apply:** the lesson asks which strand is over- or under-expressed, never which is good. If tamas could be escaped there would be “no body, no shape, no continuity, no skeleton”.
- **Tracker:** three strands (form, rhythm, equilibrium); trebling lifts tamas to rajas and rajas to sattva; the architecture lives in three dimensions as the torus. The lesson says the diagram is drawn and “the geometric model is now in hand”.

# 4.2 The Architecture of Manifestation: The Ritam Diagram: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

### What I want to remember

### Questions I would like to ask

### Where I notice this in my own life

# Lesson 4.3: The Mind through the Lens of RWF I: The Wave Equation

**Aim:** to bring the architecture home to your own mental life, reading Module 3's wave equation as the framework in motion and as a diagnostic instrument. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 4.3 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

## 1 In my own words

In three sentences, say in plain words what each term of the equation stands for, and why the lesson says the guṇas cannot be attached to the terms one to one.

## 2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

| Term | In my own words |
|---|---|
| $\psi_x(t)$, the object wave | |
| $h(t)$, the saṁskāric filter | |
| $G(t)$, the gain | |
| $\psi_m(t)$, the attention wave | |
| $n(t)$, the noise term | |
| Vṛtti, the resultant | |
| Envelope and carrier | |
| Standing tilt, $\Delta\varphi$ | |

## 3 Fill the gaps

$G(t)$, the amplitude of the attention wave, is set by the _____ and prāṇa.

When the conditioned object wave meets the gained attention wave, the whole resultant is called the _____: one wave with two nested layers.

Doubling holds the duality of the mind; _____ lifts the system out of it.

## 4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

*"The witness-awareness is one more term of the equation."*

*"Each term has one guṇa: the filter is tamasic, attention rajasic, gain sattvic."*

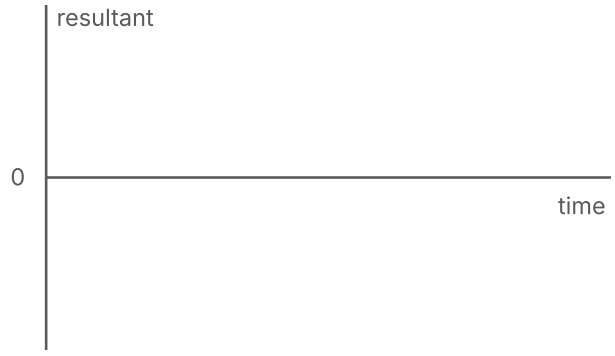
# Lesson 4.3: The Mind through the Lens of RWF I: The Wave Equation

(continued)

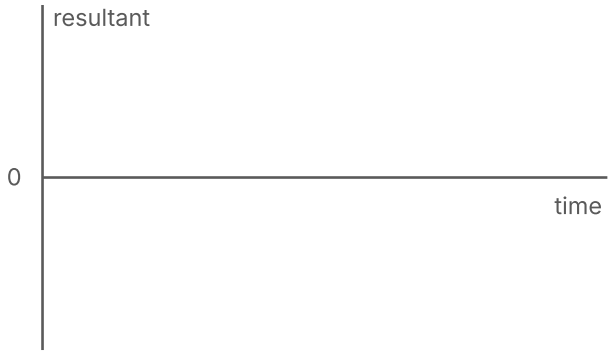
## 5 Draw it in your own way

**Figure 4.3.b.** The lesson's caption reads: “The resultant of the meeting is one vṛtti with two nested layers: a carrier (the content layer, jointly authored at the mean frequency) inside an envelope (the clarity layer, the felt flicker of duality beating at $|f_s - f_m|$). Citta-vṛtti-nirodha stills the envelope into constant fullness.” In each frame sketch the resultant as the lesson describes it, marking the carrier and the envelope.

**Δf large: mind far from its object**




**Δf = 0 and Δφ = 0**




## 6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Before giving a talk, Leilani's breath is fast and shallow, her thoughts jump about, and a friend's kind remark lands as criticism. Using the lesson's terms, say what the remark is, which term has already reshaped it before she meets it, which term the breath is linked to, and what the lesson says the breath does and does not do. Do not describe yourself.

## 7 Tracker

In 4.2 the Ritam Diagram was built from the three strands. In the lesson's own notation, say what Lesson 4.3 adds: what the body and prāṇa set, what manas sets, what the meeting forms, and where the witness stands. End with the equation as the lesson writes it.

## 8 Check my notes

Key points for 4.3 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

# 4.3 The Mind through the Lens of RWF I: The Wave Equation

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

## The main ideas

- Movement 1: in a thought you can notice form (its shape), rhythm (the cadence of thoughts and gaps, beside the breath) and equilibrium (the steadiness in which the witness is noticed). Every thought contains all three.
- Every component carries all three guṇas in different proportions (its guṇa-mix). Practice changes the mix of saṁskāras in chitta; it does not remove h(t).
- $\psi exp(t) = [\psi_x(t) * h(t)] + G(t) \cdot \psi_m(t) + n(t)$. $\psi_x$ is what is present in the world; h(t) the filter formed by chitta's saṁskāras; $\psi_m$ the attention wave, its frequency $f_m$ set by manas; G(t) its amplitude, set by the body and prāṇa; n(t) noise.
- For G(t) the lesson describes a top-down regime (buddhi directs manas) and a bottom-up regime (the body's arousal drives attention). The breath steadies G(t) in the moment but does not by itself reshape deeper conditioning.
- n(t) is the "spectral measure of anṛta". When it is high the mind is not broken, it is misfitted: a structural state, not a moral failing.
- The meeting forms one resultant, the vṛtti. The carrier (mean frequency) is the content layer; the envelope, beating at $|f_s - f_m|$, is the clarity layer. At $\Delta f = 0$ the envelope stops fluctuating; citta-vṛtti-nirodha, the stilling of the mind's fluctuations, settles it into constancy.
- Ahaṁkāra is not produced by the meeting: it is the standing tilt $\Delta\varphi$ the attention wave brings to it. In samādhi the tilt is released through buddhi's correction.
- Doubling, the loop {1, 2, 4, 8, 7, 5}, is the duality of mental life; effort only doubles it. Trebling lifts it to {3, 6}, then {9}. The horizon, 9 into 0 (Self-Recognition), lies beyond the equation.
- The witness-awareness, the "0" of the diagram, is not a term in the equation: ψexp appears in chitta, and chitta appears in the witness.

## Terms

| | |
|---|---|
| **Vṛtti (resultant)** | The whole wave of the meeting: a content layer and a clarity layer. |
| **Envelope and carrier** | Slow swell and fade (clarity); fast oscillation inside it (content). |
| **G(t)** | The time-varying amplitude of the attention wave, the intensity of engagement. |
| **Δφ** | The standing phase-offset the attention wave brings to every meeting: ahaṁkāra. |
| **Doubling / trebling** | Doubling stays within the loop of duality; trebling lifts to the next level. |

## Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** body; vṛtti; trebling.
- **Slips:** the witness is not a term: it is the awareness in which chitta, the field where the waves meet, appears. No term has a single guṇa: every component carries all three and what differs is which predominates.
- **Figure:** with Δf large, a fast oscillation inside a rapidly swelling and fading envelope; at $\Delta f = 0$ and $\Delta\varphi = 0$, one wave of constant fullness, no fluctuating envelope.
- **Apply:** the remark is $\psi_x$; h(t) reshaped it; the breath links to G(t), steadying arousal in the moment but not by itself reshaping deeper conditioning.
- **Tracker:** G(t) set by the body and prāṇa; manas setting $f_m$, with the standing tilt Δφ; the meeting forming the vṛtti (carrier and envelope); the witness not a term. The lesson's equation: $\psi exp(t) = [\psi_x(t) * h(t)] + G(t) \cdot \psi_m(t) + n(t)$.

# 4.3 The Mind through the Lens of RWF I: The Wave Equation: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

### What I want to remember

### Questions I would like to ask

### Where I notice this in my own life

# Lesson 4.4: Mind through the Lens of RWF II: The Inner Instrument

**Aim:** to place the inner instrument (antaḥkaraṇa) and the field of chitta in the wave equation, anchor them in the Kaṭha Upaniṣad's chariot, and read a moment of mental life through both lenses. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 4.4 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

## 1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what manas, buddhi and ahaṁkāra each do in the equation, what chitta is, and what the lesson says sets G(t).

## 2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

| Term | In my own words |
|---|---|
| Antaḥkaraṇa, the inner instrument | |
| Manas | |
| Buddhi | |
| Ahaṁkāra, two faces | |
| Chitta | |
| Chariot (Kaṭha Upaniṣad) | |
| Top-down regime | |
| Bottom-up regime | |

## 3 Fill the gaps

In the chariot image the body is the chariot, the senses are the horses, buddhi is the charioteer and manas is the _____.

Chitta is the field in which the two waves meet, and the saṁskāras recorded in it form the filter _____.

The lesson says the mind is not broken when n(t) is high: it is _____.

## 4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

*"A mind in the bottom-up regime shows that something is wrong with the person's character."*

*"Ahaṁkāra is a thought about the self that arises after the meeting."*

# Lesson 4.4: Mind through the Lens of RWF II: The Inner Instrument

(continued)

## 5 Draw it in your own way

**Figure 4.4.a.** The lesson's caption reads: “The Kaṭha Upaniṣad's chariot fixes the hierarchy of the inner instrument: the Self rides, buddhi is the charioteer holding the reins, manas is the reins, the senses are the horses, and the body is the chariot. Cultivation restores this top-down order.” Sketch the chariot in each frame, in any way you like, and label its parts. In the first, show the direction in which governance flows when buddhi holds the reins. In the second, show how the lesson says it flows in the default bottom-up regime.

**Cultivated: top-down**

**Default: bottom-up**

## 6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Before a difficult conversation Hana notices her attention darting, her breath fast and shallow, and the thought “this is my problem” tagging everything as hers. Using the lesson's two lenses, say which regime the chariot is in, where each of the darting attention, the breath and the tagging sits in the equation, and where the lesson says the most accessible entry point is. Do not describe yourself.

## 7 Tracker

In 4.3 the equation was $\psi exp(t) = [\psi_x(t) * h(t)] + G(t) \cdot \psi_m(t) + n(t)$. In the lesson's own words, write who or what stands behind each term, and what the chariot fixes. End with the lesson's own summary line.

## 8 Check my notes

Key points for 4.4 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

# 4.4 Mind through the Lens of RWF II: The Inner Instrument

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

## The main ideas

- What produces the equation? The antaḥkaraṇa: manas, buddhi and ahaṁkāra acting in the field of chitta. The lesson says the Vedāntic and wave models are one architecture seen structurally and dynamically.
- The chariot (Kaṭha Upaniṣad I.iii.3-9): body the chariot, senses the horses, manas the reins, buddhi the charioteer, the Self the master who rides. The cultivated flow is top-down. It shows who steadies what; it is not a serial chain, and the body and prāṇa set G(t).
- In the default bottom-up regime the body's activation drives manas and buddhi loses grip. The lesson's image: anxiety is horses bolting, depression horses lying down; none is a failure of moral character. Practice restores the direction of flow.
- Manas sets $f_m$ and reaches G(t) only indirectly, through practice under buddhi's direction; the breath is the most accessible point at which practice reaches the body and prāṇa that set G(t).
- Chitta is the field in which the waves meet, not a fourth function, and the record whose saṁskāras form h(t). Transformation is cultivating sattvic-predominant saṁskāras, not erasure.
- Buddhi adds no term: it corrects the phase (Δφ toward zero) and reads the carrier. Ahaṁkāra has two faces: posture (the standing tilt Δφ) and function (tagging moments as "mine"). Each function has its own guṇa-mix.
- Four worked examples (anxious rumination, depressive shutdown, meditative clarity, a musician in flow) are demonstrations, not diagnoses: "a structural reading, not a verdict".
- Ritam in the mind is signal-dominated, anṛta noise-dominated: structural, not moral. The mind is not broken when n(t) is high, it is misfitted, and misfit can be re-fitted.

## Terms

| | |
|---|---|
| **Antaḥkaraṇa** | The inner instrument: manas, buddhi, ahaṁkāra acting in the field of chitta. |
| **Manas** | The attention-directing function; sets the frequency $f_m$ of $\psi_m(t)$. |
| **Top-down / bottom-up** | Governance flowing from buddhi downward / the body's arousal driving manas. |

## Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** reins; h(t); misfitted.
- **Slips:** not failures of moral character but states in which the hierarchy has temporarily inverted. As posture, ahaṁkāra is brought to the meeting, not a thought that arises after it; it is the instrument's standing tilt, not a content.
- **Figure:** first frame: Self riding, buddhi holding the reins, manas the reins, senses the horses, body the chariot, governance flowing downward; second: the body's activation driving manas, buddhi losing grip. Sketches are your own.
- **Apply:** the chariot is in the bottom-up regime. Darting attention is manas and $f_m$, the breath is how practice reaches G(t), and the "this is my problem" tagging is ahaṁkāra. The lesson names the breath as the most accessible entry point.
- **Tracker:** the lesson's closing line, "Both lenses on the mind are now in hand": manas sets $f_m$, the body and prāṇa set G(t), chitta is the field whose saṁskāras form h(t), buddhi corrects the phase and reads the carrier, ahaṁkāra is the standing tilt Δφ; the chariot fixes the hierarchy.

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

# 4.4 Mind through the Lens of RWF II: The Inner Instrument: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

### What I want to remember

### Questions I would like to ask

### Where I notice this in my own life

# Lesson 4.5: Inherited Mind: Saṁskāras, Vāsanās & Memory of Energy

**Aim:** to see why the mind comes pre-shaped, not through a failure of will or attention, but through the saṁskāra (the lasting trace an experience leaves in the mind), the structural content of the filter h(t). **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 4.5 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

## 1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what a saṁskāra is, how a vāsanā differs from it, and what the lesson says h(t) is made of.

## 2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson. Brackets give the lesson's own gloss.

| Term | In my own words |
|---|---|
| Saṁskāra ("well-formed") | |
| Vāsanā ("perfuming", "lingering trace") | |
| The filter h(t) | |
| Sañcita karma ("accumulated") | |
| Prārabdha karma ("begun, set in motion") | |
| Āgāmi karma ("coming, yet to arrive") | |
| Nivṛtti saṁskāras ("turning away") | |
| The brain-locus account | |

## 3 Fill the gaps

A matching cue does not create the saṁskāra; it _____ it.

The relationship between saṁskāra and vāsanā is the same as the relationship between a habit and a _____.

Saṁskāra-formation is the only mode over which the practitioner has direct _____.

## 4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

*"A saṁskāra is a passive record, like a file that sits in storage until I look it up."*

*"Since saṁskāras are what hold a mind back, the aim is to eliminate them all."*

# Lesson 4.5: Inherited Mind (continued)

## 5 Draw it in your own way

**Figures 4.5.a and 4.5.b.** The lesson's captions read: "A saṁskāra is a self-sustaining toroidal loop of energy in the mind-field. A matching cue wakes it (it does not create it); each firing adds energy and deepens the groove; and many loops coexist without cancelling." And: "Related saṁskāras couple into a larger toroidal structure, a vāsanā: a habit becomes a disposition." (A torus is a doughnut shape: a loop that circulates.) Draw each stage in your own way, with arrows, and label what wakes the loop and what each firing adds.

| One saṁskāra | Related loops side by side | A vāsanā |
|---|---|---|
| | | |

## 6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Tama is a teacher. Whenever a colleague's voice sharpens, his chest tightens at once, even in a calm staffroom, and the same tightening comes back again and again. A friend says it must be a lack of willpower. Using the lesson's terms, say what is running in Tama, what the lesson says wakes it, and how the lesson would answer the friend. Do not describe yourself.

## 7 Tracker

Module 4 builds one picture of Ritam and drift, lesson by lesson. Write what Lesson 4.5 adds to it, in the lesson's own words: what the filter h(t) is made of, and what the lesson says follows for the way we experience anything.

## 8 Check my notes

Key points for 4.5 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

# 4.5 Inherited Mind: Saṁskāras, Vāsanās & Memory of Energy

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

## The main ideas

- The mind arrives pre-shaped; no signal reaches you unfiltered: “Nothing arrives without first passing through what you already are.” This is an architectural feature, not a failure of will or attention.
- A saṁskāra is the energetic trace of an experience repeated or intense enough to become self-sustaining: in the lesson's active sense, a loop of energy that sustains itself and fires when triggered. The lesson describes it with the torus of Lesson 4.2.
- Its properties include self-sustenance, triggered firing (a cue wakes the loop), reinforcement and non-interference. Well-worn patterns are harder to interrupt because the loop has accumulated energy, “not because of any moral weakness”.
- A vāsanā is a cluster of related saṁskāras coupled into a larger structure, as a character is to a habit: it shapes how a whole kind of situation is received.
- The structural content of h(t) is the totality of one's saṁskāras, experienced “as the world itself”. “Not a pessimistic finding”: loops can be weakened and new ones formed (Module 5). Saṁskāras are not the enemy: Ritam-aligned loops are skill, wisdom, virtue; Lesson 4.7 asks which loops generate anṛta (drift from fit).
- Where do they reside? The brain-locus account (wiring strengthens with repeated experience; predictive processing, the brain filtering the world through its past, as the description of h(t)) and the spectral-antaḥkaraṇa account (in chitta, surviving the body) converge on what saṁskāras do and diverge on where. The lesson calls the first demonstrable, the second testimonial, both real evidence, with Pribram and Bohm's model (memory as wave patterns spread across the brain) as a bridge, and asks the student to hold both open.
- The karma triad: sañcita (accumulated, mostly latent), prārabdha (“the hand dealt at the start of this life”; it “can be played well or poorly; it cannot be exchanged”), āgāmi (formed by present action). Agency lies in present response: “neither determinism nor voluntarism”.
- Nivṛtti saṁskāras, formed by practice, soften the ripening. Maa Sarada Devi: “Spiritual practices such as japa and meditation mitigate karma. Where one were to receive a deep cut, one gets a pin-prick.”

## Terms

| | |
|---|---|
| **h(t)** | The filter every signal passes through; its content is the totality of one's saṁskāras. |
| **Sañcita; prārabdha; āgāmi** | The accumulated reservoir; the ripening present; what present action forms. |

## Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** wakes; character; agency.
- **Slips:** a saṁskāra is active, a loop that fires when triggered. Not “eliminate them”: Ritam-aligned ones are valuable; the work is to weaken anṛta-generating loops.
- **Figure task:** a loop with a cue arrow and energy added per firing; loops side by side; loops coupling into a vāsanā.
- **Apply:** a saṁskāra, woken by its cue; hard to interrupt because the loop has accumulated energy, not through moral weakness.
- **Tracker:** “The structural content of the filter is the totality of one's saṁskāras”: self-sustaining toroidal loops in the mental field, so you experience nothing unfiltered.

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

# 4.5 Inherited Mind: Saṁskāras, Vāsanās & Memory of Energy: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

### What I want to remember

### Questions I would like to ask

### Where I notice this in my own life

# Lesson 4.6: Living in Harmony with Ṛta

**Aim:** to describe the felt quality of life in resonant fit (a body, a mind, a day, a relationship) and to see the physics of resonance, entrainment and coherence the lesson uses to speak about it. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 4.6 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

## 1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what the lesson means by Ṛta (right-fittedness) as a baseline, and how resonance, entrainment and coherence differ.

## 2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

| Term | In my own words |
|---|---|
| Ṛta (often written Ritam) | |
| Ṛtu | |
| Resonance | |
| Entrainment | |
| Coherence | |
| Heart rate variability (HRV) | |
| Circadian rhythm | |
| The direction of resonance | |

## 3 Fill the gaps

Ṛta is not a peak state. It is the natural _____ of a system in resonant fit.

Entrainment: two or more oscillating systems (things that repeat a cycle) with similar frequencies, when coupled through a shared medium, tend to _____.

Coherence is not uniformity. It is coordinated _____.

## 4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

*"Ṛta is a peak state, reached by extraordinary effort, and the four sketches show people who have transcended ordinary life."*

*"Resonance is a spiritual principle that always lifts a person up, whatever they are coupled to."*

# Lesson 4.6: Living in Harmony with Ṛta (continued)

## 5 Draw it in your own way

**Figure 4.6.b.** The lesson's caption reads: “Three universal phenomena. Resonance: a system driven at its natural frequency amplifies, drawing from the field. Entrainment: coupled oscillators fall into one rhythm. Coherence: many systems hold a stable phase relationship, efficiently.” Sketch each in your own way, using the lesson's own example (the wine glass, the metronomes on a board, a room of pendulums), and write one line on what makes each different from the others.

**Resonance**

**Entrainment**

**Coherence**

## 6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Hana notices that after half an hour of a fast-moving news feed she feels unsettled, and after half an hour sitting quietly she feels steadier. Using the lesson's idea of the direction of resonance, say what the lesson says is happening in both cases, and what the lesson says about a neutral state. Do not describe yourself.

## 7 Tracker

Module 4 builds one picture of Ritam and drift, lesson by lesson. Write what Lesson 4.6 adds to it, in the lesson's own words: what Ṛta is as a baseline, and what the lesson says is now in place for Lesson 4.7.

## 8 Check my notes

Key points for 4.6 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

# 4.6 Living in Harmony with Ṛta

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

## The main ideas

- The lesson gives a reference point first: what the architecture feels like when it works, then the science. Its opening practice shows heart and breath rhythms entraining: "You set the conditions; the body finds coherence."
- Four composite sketches show Ṛta in a body (Maria), a mind (James), a day (Seo-yeon) and a relationship (Daniel and his mother). None is a saint or a specialist. Ṛtu is Ritam-in-time: "a sensitivity to what the hour is asking for".
- Ṛta "is not a peak state". It is the natural baseline of a system in resonant fit, "approached rather than arrived at, and returned to after being lost": less effort to function, more access to what is already there.
- Three phenomena: resonance (a system driven at its natural frequency amplifies, drawing from the field around it), entrainment (coupled oscillators with similar frequencies tend to synchronise, as the metronomes do), coherence (many systems holding stable phase relationships: "coordinated diversity", not uniformity).
- The lesson offers three analogies (tuned receiver, resonant cavity, coupled oscillator) for how a being in fit draws energy from source. They are analogies; "resonant fit grants access, it does not create".
- The mechanism is neutral: it does not care what you couple to, and the direction of flow depends on what you are coupled to. "The mind is always entraining to something. There is no neutral state." Choosing what to resonate with is, the lesson says, "itself a yogic practice". It quotes Gītā 6.5 here: "Let a man lift his mind by his own Self alone; let him not lower his mind."
- The lesson draws on heart rate variability, cardiac coherence, nested brain rhythms, circadian timing, and cellular and social entrainment, without references: read them as the lesson's account. It holds the Schumann question (whether the Earth's electromagnetic resonance, about 7.83 Hz, entrains brain rhythms) openly: "take it seriously, do not lean on it, and remain genuinely open".
- The lesson says wellbeing practices are partial expressions of one principle: choosing one is choosing which dimension of Ṛta to restore first. Ṛta is "the ground" from which the deeper movement of practice becomes possible.

## Terms

| | |
|---|---|
| **Ṛta; ṛtu** | Right-fittedness, rhythms aligned with those that hold a being; Ritam-in-time. |
| **Resonance; entrainment; coherence** | Amplifying at the natural frequency; synchronising through a shared medium; many systems in stable phase relationship. |

## Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** baseline; synchronise; diversity.
- **Slips:** Ṛta is a natural baseline, approached and returned to, and the sketches are ordinary people. Resonance is neutral; the direction depends on what you couple to.
- **Figure task:** a glass amplifying in a matching sound field; metronomes on a shared board falling into one rhythm; pendulums phase-locked, each at its own place in the cycle.
- **Apply:** the mind entrains to whatever it is coupled to, so the two half-hours couple it to different rhythms; there is no neutral state.
- **Tracker:** "Ṛta is not a peak state" and "the natural baseline of a system in resonant fit". "The reference point is in place": Lesson 4.7 can name what happens when the architecture drifts.

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

# 4.6 Living in Harmony with Ṛta: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

### What I want to remember

### Questions I would like to ask

### Where I notice this in my own life

# Lesson 4.7: When We Drift from Ṛta

**Aim:** to understand anṛta (drift from resonant fit) as a structural condition of misfit, not a defect of the person who experiences it. **Online:** understanding check for 4.7 (vedanta.nz, My Journey); there is no Practice page for this lesson.

This page is about structure, not about you.

## 1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what anṛta means in this lesson, and what the lesson says it is not.

## 2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

| Term | In my own words |
|---|---|
| Anṛta ("not-Ṛta") | |
| Structural misfit | |
| Tamasic anṛta | |
| Rajasic anṛta | |
| The integrating axis (sattva) | |
| The four Yogas (jñāna, bhakti, karma, dhyāna) | |
| Circadian misalignment | |
| Rising disengagement | |

## 3 Fill the gaps

Anṛta is not a judgement. It is the name for a _____ condition: a system that has drifted out of resonant fit with the rhythms in which it is embedded.

Tamasic anṛta: too much form, not enough _____. Rajasic anṛta: too much movement, not enough _____.

The biological architecture is not broken. It has _____, and drift is recoverable.

## 4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

*"Anṛta is a label for people who are weak, broken or spiritually deficient."*

*"If someone finds the lesson's descriptions familiar, it means something is wrong with the person."*

# Lesson 4.7: When We Drift from Ṛta (continued)

## 5 Draw it in your own way

**Figure 4.7.a.** The lesson's caption reads: “The same equation, well-fitted (Ṛta) or misfitted (anṛta). In anṛta the filter runs old patterns, attention is over- or under-activated, the gain is too high or collapsed, and noise dominates, so experience fragments. A structural misfit, not a defect of the person.” In each frame, sketch the same four parts in your own way (the filter h(t), the attention wave $\psi_m(t)$, the gain G(t), the noise n(t)), once as the lesson describes them in Ṛta and once in anṛta.

**Well-fitted (Ṛta)**

**Misfitted (anṛta)**

## 6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Ana has practised japa and meditation steadily for a year. She now spends fewer evenings on late-night scrolling and idle company, and she is more available to her family and her work. A friend worries that Ana is “withdrawing”. Using the lesson's wording, say how the lesson tells this apart from the withdrawal of tamasic anṛta, and what it says to look for. Do not describe yourself.

## 7 Tracker

Module 4 builds one picture of Ritam and drift, lesson by lesson. Write what Lesson 4.7 adds to it, in the lesson's own words: what anṛta is, and what the lesson says about the biological architecture.

## 8 Check my notes

Key points for 4.7 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

# 4.7 When We Drift from Ṛta

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

## The main ideas

- The framing comes first and "does not change in any of what follows": anṛta "is not a judgement", not a label for weak, broken or spiritually deficient people. A system can drift "through no fault of its own", through its environment and through patterns inherited before the present self had a say. Struggle is intrinsic to embodied life; what separates Ritam from anṛta is the quality of fit in meeting it.
- Anṛta (an + ṛta, "not-Ṛta") is "not moral falsehood but ontological misfit": loss of phase-lock between a person's own rhythms and the larger rhythms around them. The lesson keeps clinical differences real: a person with clinical depression is not simply "stressed".
- In the equation: in Ritam the filter matches the situation, attention is engaged, the gain is calibrated and n(t) is small. In anṛta, h(t) runs patterns that do not match the present, $\psi_m$ is over- or under-activated, G(t) is too high or too low, and n(t) dominates. "The equation is still running."
- The lesson lists structural signatures (fatigue that rest does not restore, sleep without recovery, anxiety with no specific cause, and others), "not diagnostic criteria". "Familiarity … does not signal personal failure."
- Two guṇa-types: tamasic (too much form, not enough movement) and rajasic (too much movement, not enough equilibrium). The lesson links depressive shutdown with the first and anxiety and burnout with the second: its own correspondence, not a diagnostic rule. For both, return is by restoring sattva, the integrating axis.
- The lesson reads Arjuna's despondency (Gītā 1.29 to 30) as acute mixed anṛta, and Sri Krishna's response as diagnosis (drift from the Self) and prescription (the four Yogas). Sañcita, prārabdha and āgāmi give anṛta temporal depth; agency lies in the saṁskāras formed now: "empowering, not deterministic".
- The lesson cites HRV, cortisol, circadian and social rhythm research without references: its account. Its point: "The biological architecture is not broken. It has drifted. And drift is recoverable."
- Rising disengagement from idle stimulation is "not a form of anṛta" but a positive sign; falling disengagement is the withdrawal of tamasic anṛta. Ritam "is the condition under which the destination becomes pursuable". Gītā 6.5, as this lesson words it: "let a man lift the self by the Self; let him not lower the self."

## Terms

| | |
|---|---|
| **Anṛta** | Drift from resonant fit: a structural condition of misfit, not a defect of the person. |
| **Integrating axis** | Sattva, which holds form and rhythm together; the direction of return for both types. |

## Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** structural; movement, equilibrium; drifted.
- **Slips:** anṛta is a structural condition of misfit, not a defect of the person. Familiarity signals recognition of a condition, not personal failure.
- **Figure task:** Ṛta: filter matches the situation, attention engaged, gain calibrated, noise small. Anṛta: filter runs old patterns, attention over- or under-activated, gain too high or collapsed, noise dominates.
- **Apply:** rising disengagement, a Ritam-aligned movement, leaves a person more available to relationship, responsibility and life; tamasic withdrawal leaves them less available.
- **Tracker:** "drift from resonant fit, the unified principle behind suffering"; "The biological architecture is not broken; it has drifted, and drift is recoverable."

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

# 4.7 When We Drift from Ṛta: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

## What I want to remember

## Questions I would like to ask

## Where I notice this in my own life